Peer Review & Feedback Report: HAAG Organizational Initiatives

1. Introduction:

This report contains my peer reviews for three HAAG procedures, including the HPC Job Submission Validation and the PACE ICE Volunteer Access SOP.

All three of these initiatives do a great job identifying real bottlenecks that slow down researchers. However, they share one main weakness: they rely too much on users voluntarily reading and following the new rules.

Because of this, my feedback across all three reviews focuses on how to guarantee adoption. Instead of just hoping researchers follow the documentation, I recommended using automated tools—like mandatory forms, wrapper scripts, and calendar bots—to make the right way the *only* way. The detailed reviews for each procedure are below.

Peer Review & Feedback Report 1

Which procedures did you review (Person, Working Group, and procedure title)?

- **Person:** Sophia Nguyen
- **Working Group:** HAAG
- **Procedure Title:** HPC Job Submission Validation

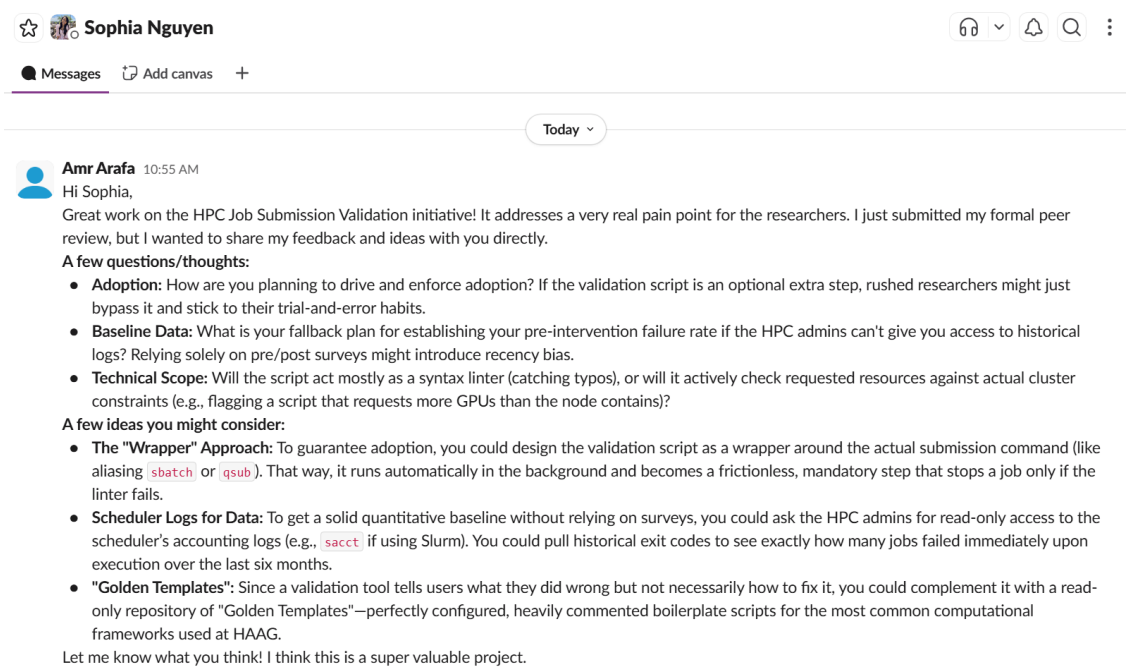
What questions do you have about their procedure that are not answered?

1. **How will you drive and enforce adoption?** The proposed workflow relies on the researcher actively remembering to run the validation script before submitting. If it is an optional extra step, how will you prevent rushed researchers from simply bypassing it and reverting to trial and error?
2. **How will you establish a quantitative baseline if historical data is inaccessible?** You mentioned that you do not yet know if historical job failure data exists. If the HPC admins cannot provide system logs, what is your fallback plan for measuring the pre-intervention failure rate? Relying solely on pre/post surveys introduces heavy recency bias.
3. **What is the technical scope of the validation?** Will this script only act as a syntax linter (catching typos), or will it actively check requested resources

against the actual cluster constraints (e.g., flagging a script that requests more GPUs than the node contains)?

What ideas do you have to share with respect to this procedure?

- **The "Wrapper" Approach (System Design):** The biggest risk to this initiative isn't technical; it is user behavior. To guarantee adoption, consider designing the validation script as a wrapper around the actual submission command (e.g., aliasing sbatch or qsub). This makes the validation step mandatory and frictionless—it runs automatically in the background when they try to submit, stopping the job and throwing an error only if the linter fails.
- **Data Collection via Scheduler Logs:** To get your baseline without relying on surveys, ask the HPC administrators for read-only access to the scheduler's accounting logs (such as sacct if the cluster uses Slurm). You can easily pull historical exit codes to see exactly how many jobs failed immediately upon execution over the last six months.
- **The "Golden Template" Repository:** While a validation tool tells a researcher what they did wrong, it doesn't always tell them how to do it right. Alongside your script, I recommend creating a centralized, read-only repository of "Golden Templates"—perfectly configured, heavily commented boilerplate scripts for the most common computational frameworks used at HAAG. You can point the validation script's error outputs directly to these templates for quick fixes.



Peer Review & Feedback Report 2

Which procedures did you review (Person, Working Group, and procedure title)?

- **Person:** Abhinav Vemuri
- **Working Group:** HAAG
- **Procedure Title:** PACE ICE Volunteer Access SOP

What questions do you have about their procedure that are not answered?

1. **How will you enforce adoption and prevent users from skipping steps?** You mentioned that adoption varies and users are skipping steps or missing info. If the SOP is just a GitHub README, how do you prevent users from reverting to their old habit of "asking around/emailing randomly"?
2. **Who owns the semester renewal process?** The initiative mentions a semester renewal process, but who is responsible for initiating it? Does the volunteer have to remember, or does the project lead track it?
3. **Can you mitigate the external admin delays?** Since PACE admin review is an external bottleneck, is there a way to batch volunteer access requests at the start/end of the semester to make it easier for the admins to process them all at once?

What ideas do you have to share with respect to this procedure?

- **Use a Forced-Entry Form:** To completely eliminate the "incomplete info" and "users skipping steps" obstacles, move the checklist out of a standard README and into a required Google Form (or Microsoft Form). If they don't fill out every required field, they physically cannot submit the request. You can then use Zapier or a webhook to automatically format their answers into the PACE Support Ticket.
- **Proactive Renewal Automations:** To ensure researchers successfully maintain access across semesters, set up an automated calendar reminder or Slack/Discord bot that pings all project leads 3 weeks before the end of the semester to gather renewal approvals *before* access drops.
- **Centralized Status Tracking:** Create a simple Kanban board (like a GitHub Project board) to track the status of these requests (e.g. "Missing Info," "Waiting on PACE Admin," "Access Confirmed"). This increases visibility for everyone and stops researchers from repeatedly asking project leads about their access status.

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Abhinav Vemuri

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Today

Amr Arafa 11:01 AM

Hi Abhinav, I just finished reviewing your PACE ICE Volunteer Access SOP for the peer review assignment. This is a super practical initiative—standardizing that access pipeline is definitely going to save HAAG project leads a lot of headaches.

I posted my official feedback on the board, but I wanted to share a few thoughts with you directly.

A few questions that came to mind: How are you planning to force users to actually follow the steps so they don't skip info? Also, who is responsible for remembering to do the semester renewals?

I also left a few ideas you might consider:

- **Create a Submission Form:** Instead of just having a README checklist, you could make a mandatory Google/Microsoft Form. If they don't fill out every required field, it won't let them submit. That completely kills the "missing info" bottleneck!
- **Automated Renewal Pings:** You could set up an automated calendar invite or bot that pings volunteers 2-3 weeks before the semester ends so renewals are proactive rather than reactive.
- **Batching Requests:** To help with the PACE admin delays, maybe you could batch all the requests at the start of the semester so the admins can clear them all at once?

Let me know what you think! Great work putting this together.

Peer Review & Feedback Report 3

Which procedures did you review (Person, Working Group, and procedure title)?

- **Person:** Peninah Waweru
- **Working Group:** HAAG
- **Procedure Title:** PACE ICE Volunteer Access SOP

What questions do you have about their procedure that are not answered?

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What ideas do you have to share with respect to this procedure?

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Peninah Waweru

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Today

Amr Arafa 11:08 AM

Hi Peninah! I just finished reviewing your PACE ICE Volunteer Access SOP for the peer review assignment. This is a super practical initiative—standardizing that access pipeline is definitely going to save HAAG project leads a lot of headaches.

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